

February 17, 2026

CITY OF CONWAY
CITY COUNCIL MEETING
CONWAY CITY HALL
229 MAIN STREET, CONWAY
TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 17, 2026

PRESENT: Mayor Barbara Jo Blain, Mayor Pro Tem Beth Helms, Amanda Butler, William Goldfinch, Julie Hardwick, Justin Jordan, Larry White.

STAFF: Adam Emrick, City Administrator; Mary Catherine Hyman, Deputy City Administrator; John Rogers, Deputy City Administrator; June Wood, Public Information Officer; Jeff Leveille, Technology Services Director; Jason Perzan, Fire Chief; Reggie Jenerette, Solid Waste Director; Robert Cooper, Construction Services Director; Lynn Smith, Human Resource Director; Ted Dudley, Public Utilities Director; Jessica Hucks, Planning and Development Director; Braxton Fleming, Public Works Deputy Director; Dale Long, Police Chief; Timmy Williams, Hospitality and Beautification Director; Kayla Fleming, Municipal Judge; Ashley Smith, Parks and Recreation Director; Kelli Thomas, Deputy PIO; Bobby Wallace, Fleet Maintenance Director; Charlotte Peterson, Assistant Planner; Nancy Alvarez, Assistant Planner; Kim Wilkerson, Planning and Development Deputy Director and Alicia Shelley, City Clerk.

OTHERS: There were approximately 25 others in attendance.

CALL TO ORDER: Mayor Blain called the meeting to order.

INVOCATION/PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE: Hardwick gave the invocation and led the Pledge of Allegiance.

The requirements for posting notice of this meeting under South Carolina's Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) were met.

CONSENT AGENDA:

- A. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-02-02 (A) to annex approximately 0.22+/- acres of property located at 250 Chevy Chase Drive (PIN 367-13-01-0031).**
- B. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-02-02 (C) to rezone approximately 0.22+/- acres of property located at 250 Chevy Chase Drive (PIN 367-13-01-0031) from the Horry County Residential, including mobile homes (MSF10) district to the City of Conway Low/Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district upon annexation.**
- C. Final Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-02-02 (D) to rezone approximately 50.64+/- acres of property located on E. Country Club Drive (PIN 339-00-00-0026), from the City of Conway Low/ Medium Residential (R-1) to the City of Conway Conservation Preservation (CP).**
- D. Approval of a Special Event - Waccamaw Sportsmen's Expo – March 26-28, 2026**

E. Approval of a Special Event – Halloween Hustle – October 3, 2026

F. Approval of a bid for the purchase of a CNC Machine for the Construction Services Department (budgeted)

G. Approval of January 20, 2026 City Council Meeting Minutes

APPROVAL OF CONSENT AGENDA: **Motion:** Butler made a motion, seconded by White to approve the February 17, 2026 consent agenda. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

SPECIAL PRESENTATION:

A. Presentation of Longevity Awards – January 2026 – 5 Years – Nickey Richardson, Police; 25 Years – Jason Perzan, Fire – Emrick and Goldfinch presented the longevity awards.

B. Proclamation Honoring Black History Month – Blain presented the Black History Month Proclamation to Cheryl Moore Adamson and others in attendance.

C. Conway Downtown Alive Annual Visitor Center Update – Hillary Howard – Howard, Executive Director of Conway Downtown Alive gave an annual visitor center update to Council.

D. Update on the 2025-26 Mayor’s Youth Advisory Council – Rogers introduced the Junior Mayor of Conway, Skyler Platt. Platt gave council an update on their work which involves a mural at Riverfront Park, Recycling Program at Conway High School, and helped with a Toy Drive and Movie Night at the Terrace in December. Platt said that the youth council hopes to make this years project a fundraising drive but will have more later. Platt said that the youth council has made several recommendations for councils’ consideration at their budget retreat.

E. Discussion of a request to rezone approximately 5.28 +/- total acres of property located at 2578 Hwy 378 (PIN 337-10-03-0010), from the Highway Commercial (HC) district to the Heavy Industrial (HI) district. Peterson stated that this property is currently zoned Highway Commercial and the applicant is requesting to rezone the property to the Heavy Industrial district, which is a district intended to accommodate heavy manufacturing, distribution, and processing uses. The applicant has applied for a business license to display and sell heavy equipment. Similar uses that are identified in the UDO, such as storage/shed sales and manufactured or modular home sales, are only permitted with the Light and Heavy Industrial districts. Heavy equipment includes large scale, earth moving construction equipment, such as bulldozers, excavators, cranes, graders, compactors, forklifts, and similar equipment, including attachments for such equipment. As such, the Zoning Administrator determined that the proposed use could not be permitted in the Highway Commercial district, prompting the request to rezone the property. The city’s future land use map designates this property as Highway Commercial, which is intended for auto-oriented commercial development along major arterial roads and

highway corridors. The adjacent properties on either side are zoned Highway Commercial, however their existing uses are more industrial in character, as and while not directly across for the subject property, there are properties across Highway 378 that are zoned Heavy Industrial upon being annexed and another property that contains a similar use, but currently in the county's jurisdiction. Peterson said that Planning Commission will hold a public hearing on the request at their March 5 meeting, and their recommendation will be forwarded at the first reading of the ordinance to rezone the property.

Blain had concerns that if the property became Heavy Industrial and the intended current use goes out of business at how close it would be to residential.

Goldfinch said that it is very close to other industrial, but he has concerns saying that the city has spent a lot of money on getting this gateway corridor looking nice.

Peterson said that across Highway 378 and further down are some industrial uses, but the adjacent uses are Highway Commercial and that the future land use map does show this property as Highway Commercial.

White asked if the adjacent property owners had been notified. Peterson said yes, all within 200 feet have been notified.

FIRST READING:

- A. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-04-20 (A) to annex approximately 1.08 +/- acres of property located off Cates Bay Hwy (PIN 369-11-04-0004).** Alvarez stated that this property is a part of the Horry County Sandridge Park off Cates Bay Highway. The subject property has been owned by Sandridge Community Improvement Council since 1981. It is accessed via a private easement road from Cates Bay Highway, not a public road. The parcel is adjacent to the New Castle subdivision zoned R-1, which is low/medium residential that is within city limits. Additionally, the property abuts the proposed Conway Perimeter Road. The property currently contains picnic tables and a covered picnic structure. The applicant is within the city utility service area and has previously received city services. However, due to a prolonged lapse in service, city public utilities are requiring a new service connection promoting the applicant to request annexation. Should Council approve first reading of the ordinance to annex the subject property, Planning Commission will hold a public hearing on the requested zoning at their April 2 meeting. Alvarez said that given the fact that the property is owned by the Sandridge Community Improvement Council and used in conjunction with a Horry County Park and doesn't have adequate frontage from a public road, staff recommends against annexation of the subject property at this time.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by White to deny first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-04-20 (A) annexing the property located off Cates Bay Highway. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

- B. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (D) to rezone approximately 1.0+/- acres of property at 3000 Hwy 378 (PIN: 337-16-04-0011) from the Horry County Highway Commercial (HC) district to the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.** Hucks stated that first reading to annex this property was approved at the January 5 council meeting. The property was previously used as a car dealership, and it was sold in October of last year. Restrictive Covenants have been on file since 1991. As part of the annexation process, the property must be assigned a city zoning district upon annexation. The current zoning of the property is Horry County Highway Commercial, and the requesting zoning upon annexation is also Highway Commercial, which is consistent with the city's future land use map. Hucks said that Planning Commission held the required public hearing on the proposed zoning of the property at their February 5 meeting and recommended approval.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (D) rezoning the property at 3000 Highway 378 to City of Conway Highway Commercial. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried

- C. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (E) to rezone approximately 0.43+/- acres of property at 1322 and 1324 Cottage Lane (PINs: 338-10-02-0005 & -0006) from the Horry County Highway Commercial (HC) district to the City of Conway Low/Medium-Density Residential (R-1) district, or alternatively, the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.** Hucks stated that first reading to annex these parcels was approved at the January 5 council meeting. Both properties contain a single-family dwelling and owned by the same individual. Restrictive Covenants were recorded for the parcels in November of 2025. Cottage Lane is one of the most notable donut holes within the city's boundaries, however, the annexation of these two parcels along with an abutting parcel will almost completely close this gap, leaving just one remaining undeveloped parcel that will be subject to annexation. The applicant requested to annex the properties as R-1, and Horry County's version of the Highway Commercial district permits single family residential. However, the property is completely surrounded by City of Conway Highway Commercial, and the city's future land use map identifies the properties as Highway Commercial. Annexation as Highway Commercial does not prohibit the current use of the property but does prohibit expansion of the current use. Hucks said that Planning Commission held a public hearing on the request at their February 5 meeting, in which R-1 and HC districts were considered, and recommended that the property be zoned to Highway Commercial upon annexation. Staff also recommends approval of first reading of the ordinance to zone the property Highway Commercial.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Jordan to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (E) rezoning the property at 1322 and 1324 Cottage Lane to the City of Conway Highway Commercial. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried

- D. First Reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (F) to rezone approximately 0.22+/- acres of property at 1326 Cottage Lane (PIN: 338-10-02-007) from the Horry**

County Highway Commercial (HC) district to the City of Conway Highway Commercial (HC) district.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Blain to approve first reading of Ordinance #ZA2026-03-16 (F) rezoning the property at 1326 Cottage Lane to City of Conway Highway Commercial. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried

- E. First reading of Ordinance #2026-03-16 (G), an ordinance authorizing the relinquishment of an existing waterline easement and the acceptance of a new 30-foot-wide waterline easement associated with the relocation and upsizing of a City of Conway water transmission line related to Santee Cooper's substation project, owned by the South Carolina Public Service Authority (Santee Cooper) and identified as PINs 369-00-00-0050, 369-00-00-0027 and 369-00-00-0028.** Dudley stated that this ordinance is the first reading to address the relocation of a city water line due to Santee Cooper's new electrical substation project off Liz Lane, behind the Food Lion on Highway 701 South. During construction the city's existing waterline conflicted with the substation footprint and was relocated. As part of the project the city upsized the line to a 30-inch transmission main to improve capacity and long-term reliability. The new line is installed and fully operational. Because the line has been relocated a portion of the original easement is no longer needed. This ordinance allows the city to release the unused easement and accept a new 30-foot easement for the relocated line. Dudley said this simply updates the legal documentation to reflect what is already in place and staff recommended approval of first reading.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve first reading of Ordinance #2026-03-16 (G) authorizing the relinquishment of an existing waterline easement and the acceptance of a new 30-foot-wide waterline easement relating to the Santee Cooper substation project as presented. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

CONSIDERATION:

- A. Consideration of approval for an extension to the non-exclusive franchise agreement issued to Randall's Culinary Creations Mobile Food Truck at the parking lot located at 7 Elm Street.** Wilkerson said that this request is consideration of approval for an extension to the non-exclusive franchise agreement that was issued to Randall's Culinary Creations Mobile Food Truck at the parking lot located at 7 Elm Street. The franchise agreement was granted by city council for a period of 1 year and expired on January 27, 2026. Wilkerson said that staff does recommend approval.

There was some discussion that if staff become dissatisfied, the franchise agreement can be canceled.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by White to approve the extension for 4 years to the non-exclusive franchise agreement to Randall's Culinary Creations Mobile Food Truck at the parking lot located at 7 Elm Street. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

B. Consideration of the purchase of a Hydroseeder for the Public Works Department.

Fleming told council that a hydroseeder is a machine that mixes grass seed, mulch, fertilizer, and water into a thick slurry and sprays it onto the ground to quickly establish vegetation, control erosion, and create lush lawns, where traditional seeding is impractical. Fleming said that the Public Works Department would like to purchase a used 2025 FINN T75 hydroseeder to replace a 2001-year model Easy Lawn hydroseeder. Since May of 2023, \$7,294.51 has been spent on repairs for the hydroseeder currently owned. Parts for this model are becoming hard to find, and some are unavailable due to the 25-year age of equipment. The cost of a new hydroseeder is estimated at \$65,000. Dobbs Equipment has a used 2025 model available with 128 hours for \$54,997.20. The money would be reallocated from the Street & Stormwater Materials and Supplies account. Fleming said that staff does approve of the purchase.

Motion: White made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve the purchase of the used hydroseeder as presented for the Public Works Department. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

PUBLIC INPUT:

- Lizzy Marlowe – spoke to council regarding the Halloween decorations at City Hall.
- Tonya Robinson – spoke to council regarding the Whittemore community.

CITY ADMINISTRATOR’S REPORT:

Emrick informed Council of the following:

- The Budget Retreat is just a few weeks away and staff should start printing the packets next week.
- The city had some very large crowds for Valentines Day. The decorations and gondola will continue running through this weekend. Then staff will do a small amount for St. Patrick’s Day before moving into Easter and Spring.
- The Recreation Department is hosting Frozen the winter dance for people with exceptional abilities this Saturday at 5 p.m. at the Sports and Fitness Center.
- The Recreation Department will also hold the State’s Largest Easter Egg Hunt on March 28th. Separate hunts for children of all ages and abilities will take place.
- John Rogers has been working diligently to improve the city’s Safety Stats and Safety Training. Part of that will include some “safety” training for Council. Representatives from MASC will do some refresher training for City Council during workshop at the April 20 meeting.
- The owners of Hop N’ Wich, Grumpy Monk, Sneaky Beagle and their new brewery have donated a very large playground to the City of Conway which is currently being installed behind Lady Bug Park and will be an amazing expansion of the playgrounds at Billy Gardner Sports Complex.

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- There are Department Head reports from Timmy Williams in Hospitality and Beautification and Chief Jason Perzon from Fire.
- There is a Workshop this afternoon regarding the historic designation of property on 15th Avenue and several executive sessions, so after completion of the Council Input section of the agenda, we should move the meeting into the Council Conference Room.

Williams and Perzan gave brief departmental reports.

COUNCIL INPUT:

Hardwick

- Thanked staff for all that they do every day and hoped all had a great Valentines weekend.

Jordan

- Thanked staff for another great holiday event and appreciated all staff that was involved with the snowstorm.

White

- Appreciates all that is done downtown but asked to spread it around to other parts of the city.

Butler

- Thanked the Whittemore Racepath Society for all the displays at the meeting.
- Recognized the Conway High School boys' and girls' basketball teams.
- Gave a shoutout to Skyler Platt of the Mayors Youth Advisory Council for a great job.

Helms

- Appreciated Rec Center staff for a successful Father Daughter Dance.
- Said that community centers and fields will be discussed at budget retreat.
- Thanked staff and looks forward to budget retreat, and doing great things for the city.

Blain

- Said that she believes that the residents are enjoying the Valentines decorations and the gondola rides.
- Said that she attended the Father Daughter dance and it was fabulous; and thanked the staff.

Workshop

Alan Todd of Conway Architectural Salvage spoke to council regarding partnering with the city to preserve neighborhoods and historic homes, explained how his business operates, permitting of the Ice House property, allowing the opening of McKeiver Shaw in stages and asked council to change city ordinances relating to demolition permits.

Todd will send other city ordinances to Council to look at to see if Conway's can be changed in a direction that would help this cause.

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EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Hardwick to enter into Executive Session for the following: (A) **Consideration of appointments to boards, commissions and committees** [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70(A) (1)]; (B) **Discussion of potential contractual agreement regarding City lease of property** [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]; and (C) **Discussion of Employment of an Employee in the Police Department** [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (1)]. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

RECONVENE FROM EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms to leave Executive Session. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried. White was absent.

POSSIBLE ACTION ON MATTERS DISCUSSED IN EXECUTIVE SESSION: Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms to approve the appointments of the following board members:

<u>Applicant</u>	<u>Board</u>	<u>Term</u>	<u>Reappointment/New</u>
Janice DeAngelis	Keep Conway Beautiful	3 Years	Reappointment
Pam Jones	Keep Conway Beautiful	3 Years	Reappointment
Joey O'Conner	Keep Conway Beautiful	3 Years	Reappointment
Chris Oglebay	Keep Conway Beautiful	3 Years	Reappointment
Dara Pegg	Keep Conway Beautiful	3 Years	Reappointment
John Creel	Lakeside Cemetery	3 Years	Reappointment

Vote: Unanimous. Motion carried. White was absent.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms, to uphold the decision of the grievance committee's recommendation regarding an employee in the Police Department. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried. White was absent.

ADJOURNMENT: Motion: Helms made a motion, seconded by Blain, to adjourn the meeting. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES: Minutes approved by City Council this 16 day of March, 2026.


Alicia Shelley, City Clerk